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LATEST NEWS

Unleashing fog of manuu Gandhi's three-day 'reality check' visit of drought-prone Bundelkhand:

JHANSI(UP): High drama was witnessed in Jhansi in Uttar Pradesh on Friday when Rahul Gandhi was stopped by the police while leading scores of farmers to meet the Divisional Commissioner provoking the young Congress leader to sit on the road on a

Rahul Gandhi

Rahul Gandhi is the son of Bena Gandhi, the President of the Indian National Congress and former Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi. He is the grandson of former Prime Minister Indira Gandhi and great grandson of Pt. Jashwanth Narain, India's first Prime Minister. His great grandfather Mohan Mahru was a distinguished leader of the Indian independence movement. He represents Amethi Lok Sabha seat in the Parliament.

Sonia Gandhi

Sonia Gandhi is the President of the Indian National Congress. Presently she represents the Rae Bareilly Lok Sabha constituency of the Parliament and is also the Chairperson of the ruling United Progressive Alliance. In the 2004 general elections Mrs. Gandhi led the Congress Party to victory. On May 16, she was unanimously elected to lead a 18 party coalition government with the support of the BJP which was subsequently named the United Progressive Alliance (UPA).

Taking India to new heights...

M K Stalin Official Website, Stalin, MK Stalin, Deputy General Secretary, DMK, Tamil Nadu

http://www.mkstalin.net

M K Stalin

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Logging On:
From GenNext leaders like Rahul (left) and Stalin (top) to Lalu, everyone's walking the digital ramp

Latest News On Lulu Yadav

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VIRTUAL LEADERS

Techno-savvy politicians are increasingly using the web as an effective medium to sell their image

By Priya Sahgal

It was love at first site. The octogenarian BJP leader L.K. Advani took one look at American presidential candidate Barack Obama's website and he wanted one just like that. And so his spin-masters camping at General Secretary Ananth Kumar's house are busy designing a virtual visage for their prime ministerial candidate. Not only will it showcase Advani's historic moments, it will also carry his itinerary and his stand on various issues. Or rather, keep updating his changing stand on various issues!

Why is it that the savviest and the smartest are hitting the keyboard? The most obvious explanation is that it is

much easier than hitting the long road of grassroots politics, though, even in a wired world, one is not the alternative to the other. As a political platform, the world wide web has no borders, and it is cheaper. It is the medium through which the virtuosos of techno-spin win unlikely friends and influence people, even if they are not the kind you find in a polling booth.

In this age of designer politics, where presentation scores over policy and gimmicks over gospel, politicians are increasingly exploring the web as an add-on marketing ploy to sell their image. Hardly surprising then, that the brat pack is way ahead of Advani in making a mark on the virtual world. Congress heir-apparent Rahul Gandhi has a comprehensive website that

tracks every move he makes spinning just the right image for him. All those who complain about Rahul's inaccessibility just have to log on to see him kissing tribal kids and embracing Dalit leaders.

It is not just Rahul, the entire Facebook generation is out there on the web marketing itself—from Milind Deora, MP from Mumbai (South) and Madhu Goud Yaskhi, NRI lawyer-turned-MP from Andhra Pradesh to a colleague from the Jat heartland, Deepender Hooda. Interestingly, they have listed their MP Local Area Development projects on their sites. This, they say makes their politics more transparent. The enterprising Deora takes his brand rather seriously. His picture appears with the tagline: